LaRoyce Jermaine Covington, Jr.

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Education

University of South Florida — **Tampa, FL**
Bachelor of Science *in Information Studies: Data Science and Analytics* — *Jun. 2017 – Dec. 2020*
Bachelor of Arts *in Political Science (Minor: Intelligence Studies)* — **GPA: 3.71**

Honors and Awards

Pi Sigma Alpha, the Political Science Honor Society — *Apr. 2019 - present*
Florida Bright Futures scholarship, full undergraduate tuition — *May 2017 - present*

Research

Big Data Analytics Lab — **School of Information, University of South Florida**
Undergraduate Research Assistant — *Jan. 2019 - present*

- Assisting Dr. Loni Hagen in original research in social network analytics and crisis communication.

Classwork and Projects

rougeR — www.github.com/LJCovingtonJr/rougeR
An R Package for Automatic Evaluation of Summaries — *Apr. 2020*

- An R implementation of Lin (2004), *ROUGE: A Package for Automatic Evaluation of Summaries*.
- Currently supports ROUGE-N with both single and multiple reference summaries, with further support in development.
- Technologies used: R, including ngram package.

SumBasicR — www.github.com/LJCovingtonJr/SumBasicR
Frequency Based Summarization Algorithm — *Apr. 2020*

- An R implementation of Nenkova and Vanderwende (2005), *The Impact of Frequency on Summarization*.

LIS 4805: Predictive Analytics — **University of South Florida**
Predicting College Rank — *Dec. 2019*

- Predicted graduation rate using university demographic and financial information using machine learning techniques
- Developed a fitted model that improved prediction accuracy.
- Technologies used: R, including caret (Classification and Regression Training) package.

LIS 4671: Intro to Data and Text Mining — **University of South Florida**
Airline Tweets Analysis — *Aug. 2019*

- Conducted a linguistic and geographic analysis of 14,640 "real air-flight related tweets" made in February 2015.
- Featured on course instructor's website at `http://bit.ly/LJC_Airline`.
- Technologies used: R, including packages dplyr, ggplot2, ggmap, and tm (text mining package).

Non-Academic Experience

University of South Florida — **Tampa, FL, USA**
Resident Assistant — *Aug. 2018 - May 2019*

- Supervised a floor of 46 residents.
- Utilized organizational and public speaking skills to create and present hall programs to implement a multi-faceted residential curriculum.
- Researched and developed creative means to engage international students.

U.S. Embassy Ottawa **Remote**
Research Intern *Sept. 2018 - Apr. 2019*

- Internship conducted as part of the Virtual Student Federal Service.
- Utilized research techniques to contribute to the 2019 Trafficking in Persons Report.
- Researched other areas of interest for the Embassy and drafted regular reports used in the decision-making process.

University of South Florida Student Government **Tampa, FL, USA**
Deputy Supervisor of Elections *Nov. 2017 - Apr. 2018*

- Developed marketing and programming events attended by more than 100 people.
- Drafted a transitional report that reviewed the current election procedures and discussed improvements.
- Served on the regulatory commission for campaigns for Student Senate and Student Body President.

Community Involvement

Young Democratic Socialists of America at USF **Tampa, FL, USA**
Steering Committee Member *Aug. 2019 - present*

- Determining the priorities and order of business of the YDSA@USF, including management of the club's general course and operations.
- Administering elections for the 2020-21 Executive Board.
- Organizing local activism events, such as the YDSA@USF Brake Light Clinic, an event where members of the public could get their brake lights replaced at no cost.

Chair, Electoral Working Group *Aug. 2019 - present*

- Serving as a liaison between YDSA@USF and the USF Bulls for Bernie campaign.
- Organizing "DSA at the DNC": a campaign encouraging local DSA members—including students—to run for delegate positions at the 2020 Democratic National Convention, Milwaukee.

President *Apr. 2018 - Apr. 2019*

- Presided over meetings, oversaw organizational functions, and acted as the primary University liaison.

Florida High Schools Model United Nations **Orlando, FL, USA**
Staff Member *Jan. 2020 - present*

- Directed educational committees on humanitarian situations among high school and middle school students while teaching policy writing, consensus building, and technical research skills during the academic year at statewide conferences.

College Democrats at USF **Tampa, FL, USA**
Secretary *Apr. 2019 - Apr. 2020*

- Managing chapter records such as meeting minutes, reservations, etc.
- Tracking and analyzing data regarding meeting attendance, outreach efforts, and club event attendance.

Membership Director *Apr. 2018 - Apr. 2019*

- Managed chapter membership lists and outreach.
- Coordinated get-out-the-vote efforts, voter registration drives, and election marketing campaigns for the USF-Tampa area during the 2018 elections.
- Organized on-campus campaign events for 2018 Democratic candidates.

Chair, Labor Caucus *Sept. 2017 - Apr. 2018*

- Chaired a committee that developed volunteering and activism-related events.
- Developed informative media regarding public policy issues relating to the labor and union movement.
- Promoted labor and employment-related issues to the USF community.

Bulls for Bernie **Tampa, FL, USA**
Volunteer *Oct. 2019 - Mar. 2020*

- Initiated phone calls to prospective voters to encourage them to vote, volunteer, and support Bernie Sanders for President.
- Distributed promotional campaign material to the public through tabling and canvassing events.

USF-Nielsen Sunshine State Survey **Tampa, FL, USA**
Question Development Team *Jan. 2018 - May 2018*

- Drafted survey questions regarding congressional apportionment for inclusion in the 2018 Survey.
- Analyzed the results of the 2017 survey and developed informative media regarding said results and their impact.

Volusia County Model United Nations **DeLand, FL, USA**
Associate Director *Aug. 2017 - Dec. 2018*

- Prepared high school students for high level competitive debate while promoting intercultural understanding and consensus building.
- Facilitated academic simulations of the United Nations.
- Chaired discussions on global issues of note.

Skills

Programming: R, Java, C++, LaTeX
Microsoft Office: Excel, Word, PowerPoint
Google Suite: Sheets, Docs, Slides
Languages: English (Native proficiency), Spanish (Professional working proficiency)